



strategy, and by hiding key training and planning from sight, beyond Varich's prying eyes.

boon

House Varich's greatest strength is their ability to discern patterns and make predictions. They can look at a week's worth of stocks and predict the market, observe a game of cards and predict who has what hand, watch a duel and predict the outcome. They require time and preparation, but once the Puppetmasters see the pattern, manipulating it comes easily. If the character has an opportunity to analyze his opponent in advance of a competition or conflict (such as fighting, sports, chess, etc.), the player can roll Perception + Kenning (difficulty 8) to successfully analyze his target's pattern of play in

that specific type of competition. While in that conflict with the target, all rolls against the target pertaining to the specific challenge have a -1 difficulty.

Flaw

Broken-hearted Varich vowed never to love again, and his house followed suit. Their perspective allows them to see the entire pattern and to manipulate it, but forces them to remain outside of it themselves, disconnected from others. They can never swear an oath of love to another, and the difficulty of Empathy rolls increases by one.

Exile

House Varich was not exiled, but carefully orchestrated both their entrance to and exit from Arcadia based on the patterns foretold through signs and portent. Even if they had been exiled, this situation would have resulted from the careful manipulation of the pattern by Varich nobility.

Factions & Societies

The Obtenyani, a group dedicated to disrupting or deviating from the pattern, are ruled by passion instead of careful planning. The Notchnytza, an elite group of all-female assassins, have mastered hand-to-hand combat, weaponry, and poisons. The Players, a ring of bookies operating out of Russian Hill, prey upon mortals and fae like, sometimes Ravaging hopeful humans dreaming of their big payout.

Notable Members

Varich, Child of the Sun and Moon, the founder of this house, who claimed the body of a dancer in a San Francisco theatre group upon his return, Rytsar Wila Irynocha, founder of the Obtenyani, who once stood in active opposition to Varich but whose views have mellowed somewhat in the decade and a half since her return, Darya Vetrov, a key figure amongst the Players, known for her particularly vicious treatment of those who fail to pay their debts, and Tzar Ivan and Tzarina Ekaterina, rulers of the Empire of the Firebird.